

V13 Virtual Esports Team

Description and Eligibility

Teams will research and develop strategies to effectively compete in a virtual esports competition. Competing teams will submit a research paper on the provided esports topic, participate in an esports tournament, and deliver a presentation highlighting the strategies employed and lessons learned. This national event will be submitted and judged virtually. Any middle level, secondary, or postsecondary contestant may enter this event. A team will consist of 2–4 contestants, depending on the division. There are no restrictions on the number of entries per chapter or per state. Teams that do not submit an entry following the topic listed below or do not follow the Copyright and/or Fair Use Guidelines and the Artificial Intelligence Usage and Citation Policy will be disqualified.

Topic

The Business of Producing Esports Events. Esports tournaments range from local competitions to international championships with millions of viewers. In a research paper of no more than three pages (double-spaced), examine the business operations involved in planning, marketing, and managing esports events.

Research Areas:

- Event planning and logistics
- Sponsorship acquisition and revenue generation
- Broadcasting and live-stream production
- Risk management and cybersecurity considerations
- Career opportunities in event operations and production

Competition Notes

- AI Policy Level 2 *Permitted with Citation*
- Contest Registration
 - Advisors register members for the event using the Membership Registration System, accessible at <https://register.bpa.org>
 - Click on the “Conferences” tab and then select the “2027 National Virtual Events”
 - There will be a \$50 fee for each team entry (*invoiced during event registration*)
 - Event registration can be purchased with your original invoice or with a new invoice after member registration
 - The registration deadline is no later than 11:59 p.m. Eastern Time on December 1, 2026
 - Contestants participating in the competition must be registered for the event prior to the submission deadline to be eligible
 - Only the team captain should complete the submission
- All teams will play Fortnite and must have a minimum of three (3) contestants. Teams may have a maximum of four contestants; not all contestants of the team are required to play during the game play round

Technical Pre-Submit Specifications

What to Submit at https://upload.bpa.org	Saved File Name(s)	National Deadline
Submit the following in one combined PDF: 1. Research paper 2. Works Cited 3. BPA Release Form(s) 4. AI Usage and Documentation Form	V13-TeamID.pdf	January 15, 2027, 11:59 p.m. Eastern Time

Contest Competencies

1. Analyze esports scenarios, gameplay data, and game characteristics to troubleshoot strategies, develop visualizations, and refine and execute strategic plans for effective competitive gameplay
2. Define and analyze how individual player personalities, play styles, and roles—including patterns observed in professional players—contribute to team dynamics and improve overall competitive performance
3. Create and communicate short- and long-term individual and team goals, incorporating time-management strategies that balance esports, academics, and personal responsibilities
4. Demonstrate effective technical reading, writing, and verbal/non-verbal communication skills to support collaboration, research, and professional presentation
5. Demonstrate healthy gaming concepts and strategies in local and virtual environments, promoting physical, mental, and social well-being in competitive settings
6. Demonstrate knowledge of intellectual property laws, legal responsibilities, and ethical standards in esports and gaming—including copyright, trademarks, DMCA, and patents—and evaluate how esports technology and social media have influenced culture, consumer behavior, and industry growth

Contest Specifications for this Event

- The research paper must *not* exceed three (3) pages single-sided (excluding Works Cited). Follow the Report format in the *Style & Reference Manual* (no Title Page required). The header on the first page should include: Contestant ID Number (Sender's ID Number - XXXXXXXX), Edna Renick (Recipient's Name), Administrative Support Department (Recipient's Department), and Current Date. In-text citations are required throughout the paper.
- Any report submitted beyond the maximum number of pages will be *disqualified*.
- Submit the final Project Files including the research paper, the Works Cited, BPA Release Form(s), and AI Usage and Documentation Form in a combined PDF file to <https://upload.bpa.org> no later than 11:59 p.m. Eastern Time, on January 15, 2027.
- Advisors of qualifying teams will be contacted to reserve a time for a videoconference presentation before a panel of judges. The dates and times for presentation reservations will be announced via email notification. Teams will be assigned to sections prior to the preliminary presentation.
- Length of presentation portion: no more than three (3) minutes for setup, no more than ten (10) minutes for the presentation, and no more than five (5) minutes for judges' questions.
- The top teams with the highest cumulative technical and presentation scores will be invited to attend the National Leadership Conference to be recognized for their outstanding efforts and to participate in the National Showcase.

Common Specifications for all BPA Judged Events

- Team ID is required for all submissions. Materials from non-registered members and/or those missing team ID cannot be accepted.
- The team is responsible for securing a BPA Release Form(s) from any person, including themselves, whose image or work is used in the project.
- The team is responsible for citing all sources, including themselves, on the Works Cited page for any work used on the project. It is the policy of Business Professionals of America to comply with copyright law. The *Style & Reference Manual* contains guidelines for Copyright and/or Fair Use. Contestants will be disqualified for violations of the guidelines.
- Materials must follow the organization's BPA Graphic Standards and make proper use of the BPA logo and/or organization's name. Refer to the BPA Graphic Standards in the *Style & Reference Manual*.
- Judges' comments will be returned digitally through the online judging system at the national level. Materials submitted for technical judging will *not* be returned and will *not* be available at NLC.

V13 Virtual Esports Team

Technical Scoring Rubric

Required Elements (If any question results in a NO, please assign a score of 0)				
Team followed the topic.				☐ Y ☐ N
Team followed Copyright and/or Fair Use Guidelines and Artificial Intelligence Usage and Citation Policy.				☐ Y ☐ N
Research Paper did not exceed three (3) pages single-sided (excluding Works Cited).				☐ Y ☐ N
If answered no to any question, please stop scoring and provide a brief reason for the <i>disqualification</i> :				
Submission and Formatting (All points or none are awarded by the technical judge)				
Team submitted one (1) combined PDF file containing the Research Paper, Works Cited formatted according to the <i>Style & Reference Manual</i> , BPA Release Form(s), and AI Usage and Documentation Form.				/10
Evaluation Criteria	Below Expectations 0-9 points	Meets Expectations 10-15 points	Above Expectations 16-20 points	Points Awarded
Introduction/Summary	Lacks clarity or fails to present key points.	Provides a clear and logical overview with supporting evidence.	Delivery of a compelling and well-supported summary that enhances understanding.	/20
Comprehension of Topic	Shows limited understanding or misinterprets key concepts.	Demonstrates solid understanding of the topic.	Shows deep insight and mastery of the subject matter.	/20
Organization & Expansion of Ideas	Ideas are disorganized or lack development.	Ideas are logically structured and supported with evidence.	Ideas are well-developed, insightful, and supported with strong analysis.	/20
Creativity	Lacks originality or relies on limited sources.	Demonstrates creativity with diverse and relevant resources.	Presents a unique and innovative perspective with rich, varied sources.	/20
Writing Accuracy	Frequent grammar or spelling errors.	Contains some grammar or spelling errors.	Contains very few or no grammar or spelling errors.	/20
TOTAL TECHNICAL POINTS				/110

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Presentation Scoring Rubric

Required Elements (If any question results in a NO, please assign a score of 0)				
Team followed the topic.				☐ Y ☐ N
Team followed Copyright and/or Fair Use Guidelines and Artificial Intelligence Usage and Citation Policy.				☐ Y ☐ N
If answered no to either question, please stop scoring and provide a brief reason for the <i>disqualification</i> :				
Evaluation Criteria	Below Expectations 0-9 points	Meets Expectations 10-15 points	Above Expectations 16-20 points	Points Awarded
Opening & Summary	The introduction is unclear or missing, and the summary lacks relevance or completeness.	The introduction sets the stage appropriately, and the summary covers the main points with adequate clarity.	The introduction is engaging and well-structured, and the summary provides a clear, insightful wrap-up that reinforces key findings.	/20
Content of Presentation	Content is unclear, lacks relevance or depth.	Content is clear, relevant, and adequately developed.	Content is insightful, well-developed, and strongly supports the presentation goals.	/20
Presentation Effectiveness	Delivery is distracting or lacks flow and engagement.	Delivery is smooth with good voice projection, transitions, and presence.	Delivery is polished, engaging, and enhances the impact of the presentation.	/20
Judges Questions	Responses lack depth and fail to demonstrate a comprehensive understanding of the topic.	Some responses lack detail or clarity. The understanding of the topic is partially demonstrated.	Responses are detailed, insightful, and effectively address the judges' questions.	/20
Team Members	At least two original team members were present during the presentation.			/5
Timing	Setup lasted no longer than three (3) minutes, and the presentation lasted no more than ten (10) minutes.			/10
TOTAL PRESENTATION POINTS				/95

Props and/or additional items shall not be used as a basis for scoring.

PRESENTATION WILL BE STOPPED AT 10 MINUTES